

Start Here



KINGB
KITS

Pairing Night

Get the party started

PRE-PARTY PLANNING

- **One cigar per guest for the whole night** - not three. A full smoke runs 45–60 minutes on its own; they pick one tier from the Pairbase chart and stick with it.
- Buying or BYO? Either works - one bottle per tier easily covers the whole group (see the math on the Pairbase page).
- Plan 2–3 small whisky pours per guest, tasted against their one cigar as it burns.

SET A DATE AND SEND INVITES

- Dress code optional - "sharp casual" reads well for this one.
- Digital or printed invite, your call - we've got both.

GATHER SUPPLIES

- Cigar cutter, matches or a butane lighter (never a regular lighter - fuel taste taints the draw).
- Rocks glasses, water pitcher, ashtray per guest.

PARTY SETUP

- Outdoors or covered patio, always - plan the whole night around it.
- A fan pointed away from the group clears smoke without killing the cherry.
- Water and a pairing card at every seat before anyone lights up.

DURING THE PARTY

- A cigar's flavor shifts as it burns - mild in the first third, fuller by the midpoint, boldest at the nub. Pour a fresh whisky taste at each stage, lightest first.
- Let each third breathe 15–20 minutes before the next pour.
- Close with a vote on the night's best pairing.

SNACK PAIRINGS

Dark chocolate, aged cheddar, dried figs, roasted nuts. Skip anything minty or garlic-heavy - both clash with the tasting notes.

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Invitation

Editable Canva template

Set up your RSVP before you send the invite:

1. [Click to copy the RSVP form](#) - your own private copy, replies land in your account, not ours.
2. Click Send in your new form and copy the link, then open the Invitation above, click the QR code, hit Edit, paste your link, and click Update code.

Know Your Leaf, Know Your Dram

Enough to sound like you've done this before.

Cigar Wrappers

The wrapper leaf drives most of a cigar's flavor and strength - more than the filler inside it.

Connecticut Shade

Pale, thin-veined, grown under cheesecloth tents in the Connecticut River Valley and Ecuador. Creamy, mild, faintly sweet - the Newbie-tier default.

Habano

Medium-brown, originally Cuban seed, now mostly grown in Nicaragua and Ecuador. Leather, pepper, and a firmer draw - the Casual-tier workhorse.

Maduro

Dark and oily from extra fermentation or fire-curing, which converts starches to sugar. Sweet, roasted, full-bodied - where the Aficionado tier lives.

Whisky Styles

Same idea as the cigar side - the style sets the intensity you're pairing against.

Bourbon

American, must be at least 51% corn and aged in new charred oak. Vanilla, caramel, corn sweetness.

Scotch

Scotland only, malted barley, minimum three years in oak. Region sets the style - Speyside runs fruity, Islay runs peated and smoky.

Irish / Canadian

Typically triple-distilled or blended for a lighter, smoother pour - the most forgiving starting point for a first pairing.

Leaf to Ash

● Harvest

Leaves are picked by hand, bottom to top of the plant - bottom primings are mildest, top leaves strongest.

● Curing

Air-cured in barns for 4-8 weeks, turning from green to brown as sugars and starches break down.

● Fermentation

Bundled leaves sweat under their own heat, releasing ammonia and deepening flavor.

● Aging

Cured leaf rests for a year or more - premium wrapper leaf often far longer.

● Rolling

Filler, binder, and wrapper are hand-rolled into the finished cigar.

The Three Thirds

First third - mildest, as the cigar warms up.

Midpoint - fullest flavor, steady burn.

Final third - boldest and warmest, often a favorite. Pour a fresh whisky taste at each stage - that's what the Pairing Cards track.

Cigar & Whisky Pairing Chart

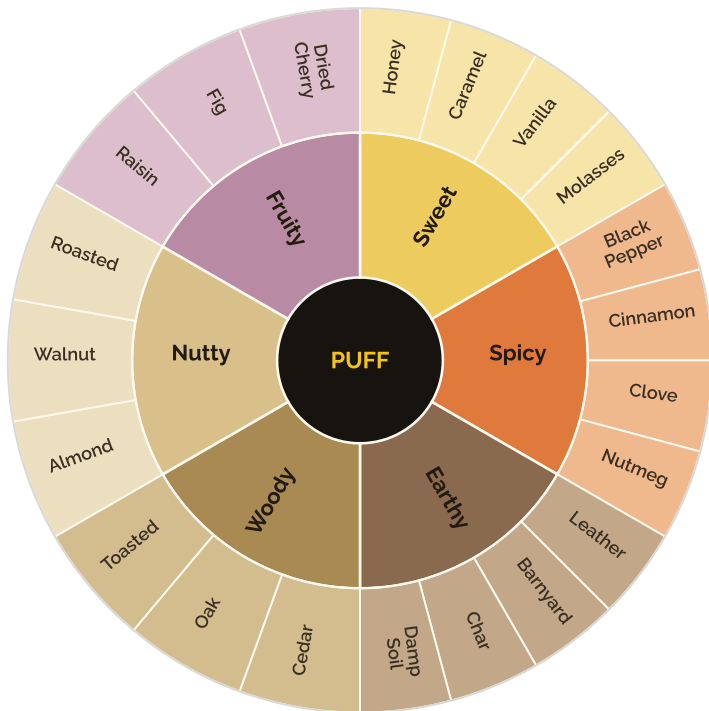
Pick a row for your cigar and starting whisky. Buy by tier, not by guesswork.

TIER	CIGAR	WHISKY	FLAVOR NOTES	COST / PERSON
Newbie	Macanudo Café Ashton Classic Romeo y Julieta 1875 Arturo Fuente Chateau Fuente	Jameson Buffalo Trace Four Roses Yellow Label Evan Williams Black	Creamy, vanilla, light spice, subtle wood	\$8–12 cigar \$25–35 / bottle
Casual	Padrón 3000 Camacho Ecuador Rocky Patel Vintage 1990 Arturo Fuente Hemingway	Glenlivet 12 Woodford Reserve Glenfiddich 12 Four Roses Small Batch	Honey, oak, caramel, light dried fruit	\$10–16 cigar \$35–55 / bottle
Aficionado	Padrón 1964 Maduro My Father Le Bijou 1922 Liga Privada No. 9 Oliva Serie V Maduro	Laphroaig 10 Ardbeg 10 Lagavulin 16 Wild Turkey Rare Breed	Smoke, leather, dark fruit, black pepper	\$14–22 cigar \$50–80+ / bottle

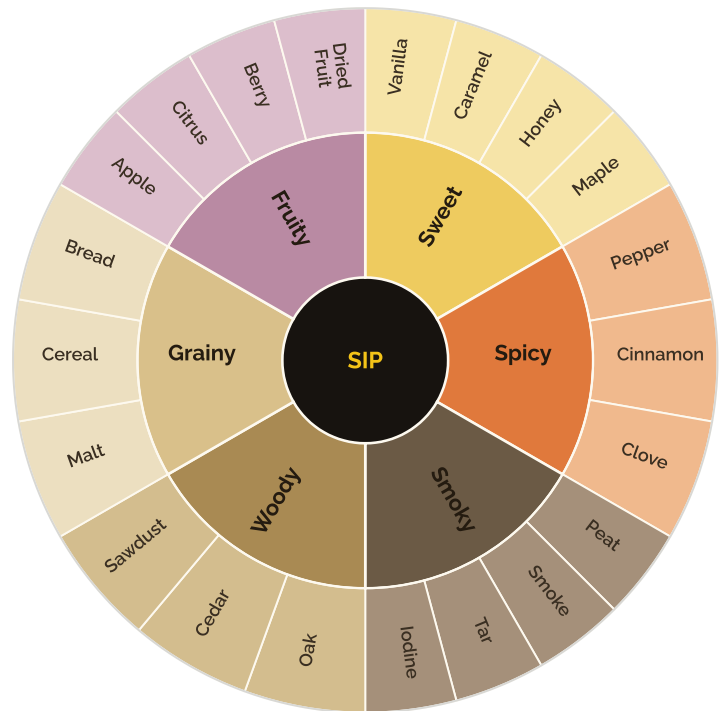
Budgeting tip: a 750ml bottle pours 25–30 tastes at 0.75 oz - even 6 guests taking 3 pours each only uses about half of it. One bottle per tier comfortably covers the whole group. The real cost driver is the cigars: budget one per guest at their chosen tier, not per pairing round.

Speak the Language of a Pairing

Start at the center tier, work outward for something more specific.



Cigar



Whisky

Using the wheels: taste first, then find the inner-ring category that fits - Sweet, Spicy, Woody, and so on. From there, work out to the specific note in the outer ring. Notice how many words show up on both wheels: that overlap is exactly what makes a pairing work.

Newbie

Mild

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Pairing Card

CONNECTICUT SHADE WRAPPER · IRISH BLEND OR YOUNG BOURBON



MY CIGAR

STARTED (TIME)

First Third

mildest



Whisky poured

Midpoint

fullest flavor



Whisky poured

Final Third

boldest



Whisky poured

FAVORITE PAIRING TONIGHT

WOULD SMOKE AGAIN?

- Light, creamy profile - a forgiving starting point for new palates.
- Keep pours small (0.5 oz); you've got three to get through on one cigar.

Casual

Medium



Pairing Card

HABANO / ECUADORIAN WRAPPER · SPEYSIDE SINGLE MALT OR STANDARD BOURBON

 MY CIGAR

STARTED (TIME)

First Third

mildest



Whisky poured

Midpoint

fullest flavor



Whisky poured

Final Third

boldest



Whisky poured

FAVORITE PAIRING TONIGHT

WOULD SMOKE AGAIN?

- Honey and oak notes should echo between the pour and the smoke.
- Most guests land here as their favorite tier - ask why.

MADURO / NICARAGUAN PURO · PEATED ISLAY SCOTCH OR CASK-STRENGTH RYE

 MY CIGAR

STARTED (TIME)

First Third

mildest



Whisky poured

Midpoint

fullest flavor



Whisky poured

Final Third

boldest



Whisky poured

FAVORITE PAIRING TONIGHT

WOULD SMOKE AGAIN?

- Smoke meets smoke - the maduro's char stands up to the peat.
- Not a beginner's lineup. Have water and a lighter snack ready.

Everything on the list, then close the night with a real ballot.

- ☐ **Cigars** - one per guest, your chosen tier (Pairbase, pg 3)
- ☐ **Whisky** - one bottle per tier, not per guest
- ☐ Cigar cutter
- ☐ Butane lighter or matches - never a fuel lighter
- ☐ Rocks glasses, one per guest
- ☐ Water pitcher and cups
- ☐ Ashtray, one per guest
- ☐ Dark chocolate, aged cheddar, dried figs, roasted nuts
- ☐ Pen at every seat for the Pairing Cards

Right glass for the table. A plain rocks glass is correct for every tier here - no need for a nosing glass. If you want to upgrade one thing for the Aficionado tier, a Glencairn glass concentrates the aroma noticeably better than a tumbler.

Pass around at the end of the night. Whichever tier gets the most votes is next month's starting point.

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